

Walmart's proposed baseline and goals are far outside what their own data supports.

Walmart's organic search traffic has fallen year over year for ten straight months and the decline is steepening. Their Annex A baseline contains none of that decline. Their \$16.4 goal sits above the most optimistic outcome our model produces at any launch date.

THEIR TREND · AUG 2026 VS AUG 2025

-23.4%

Google clicks, walmart.com. Ten consecutive months down; the last three average -20%. First five days of September: -22%.

BASELINE OVERSTATEMENT · SEP–DEC

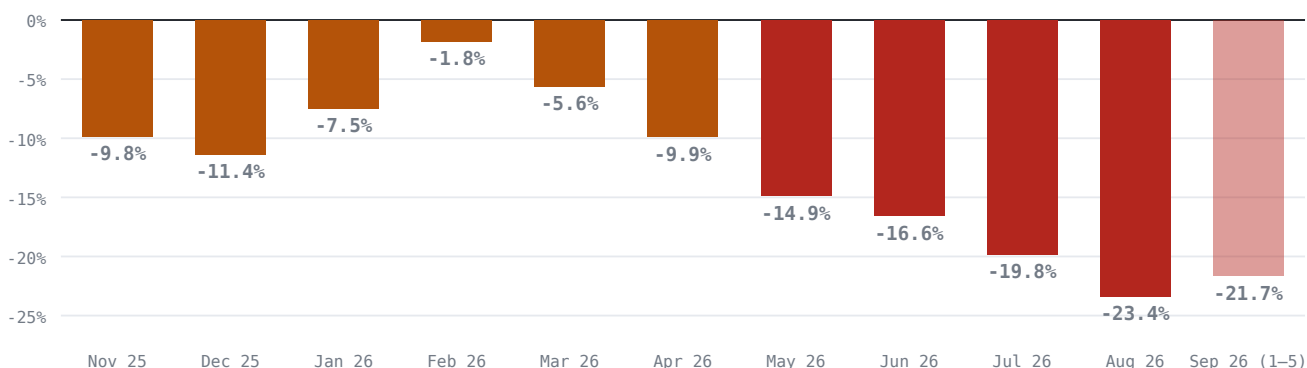
+102M

Annex A says 693M visits. Their own run-rate, seasonality and 12-month trend give 591M. On the last-3-month trend: 537M, a 156M gap.

GOAL VS OUR MOST OPTIMISTIC CASE

1.4–2.2×

45.3M incremental visits by Dec 20. Our *high* case delivers 31M (Sep 1 launch) or 20M (Sep 24). The contract's low tier: 2–3M.



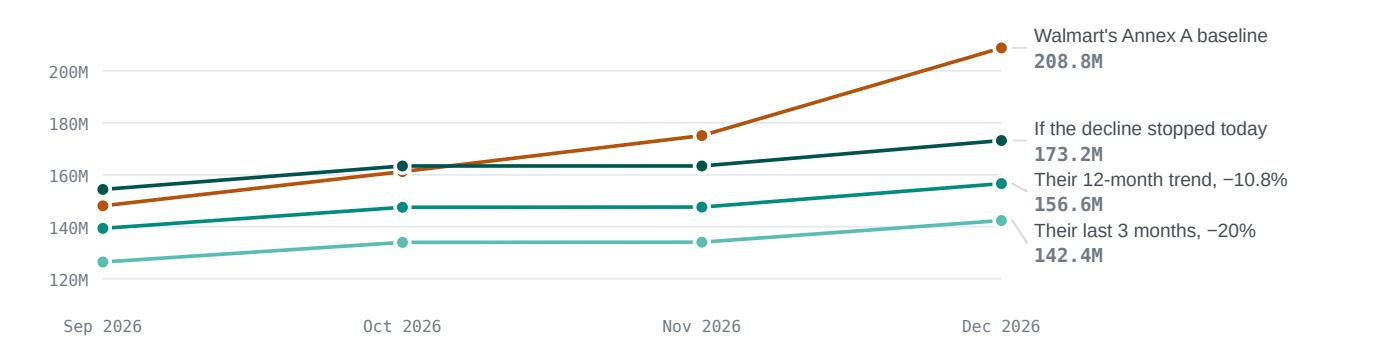
Google clicks, year over year, by month — Walmart's own Search Console data. Impressions are up over the same period, so demand is not falling; Walmart is being shown more and clicked less. Nothing here suggests a reversal before December.

Annex A says it applies "a year-over-year run-rate" to current performance. Applied to this channel, that produces a baseline *below* last year. Annex A instead embeds **+6% growth** in its search component and a September-to-December climb of 41% — three times what Walmart's organic search has ever done in Q4 (13% last year). September matches their current run-rate with zero decline; the inflation is all in November and December.

Annex A vs. a baseline built from Walmart's own numbers.

Scale from Walmart's scorecards (2.25 visits per search click — the higher of two attested weeks), shape from their Sep–Dec 2025 search history, AI visits held flat. Only the trend varies.

Annex A baseline If the decline stopped today Their 12-month trend, -10.8% Their last 3 months, -20%



2026	ANNEX A	12 -MO TRENDS	GAP	HOLIDAY SHAPE	ANNEX A	THEIR SEARCH '25	'24
Sep	148.1M	139.4M	+6%	Dec ÷ Nov	1.19	1.06	1.07
Oct	161.2M	147.5M	+9%	Dec ÷ Sep	1.41	1.13	—
Nov	175.1M	147.6M	+19%	Growth embedded, YoY	+6%	-10.8%	-20% recent
Dec	208.8M	156.6M	+33%	Visits per click required	2.66	2.18–2.25 in their scorecards	
Sep–Dec	693.2M	591.1M	+17%				

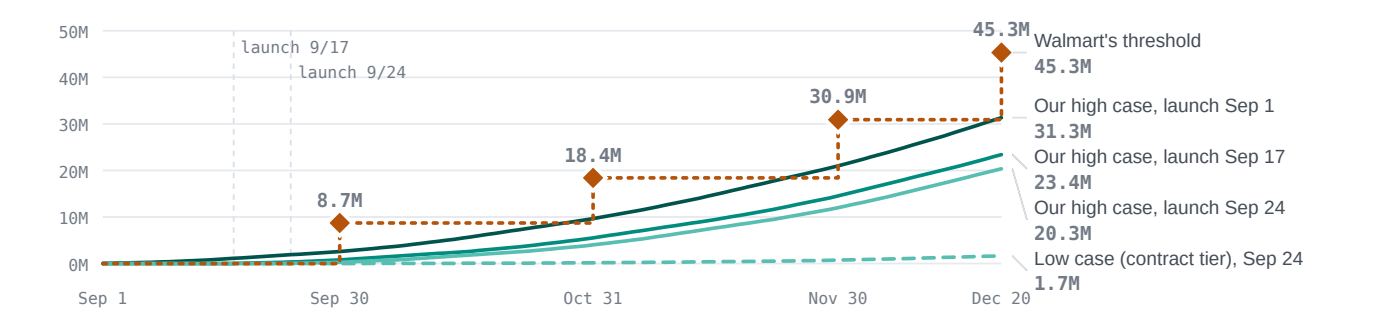
A 41% Q4 climb is what all-channel site traffic does. Organic search at Walmart does 13%, and the surge is branded queries SpeedWorkers doesn't act on.

RECORDED BEFORE WE START	WALMART'S THRESHOLD	EFFECTIVE BAR
-84M to -133M	45.3M	129M–178M
"Incremental" visits the contract would record over Sep 1 – Dec 20 if SpeedWorkers did nothing and Walmart's traffic simply followed its trend (12-month vs last-3-month trend).	The baseline deficit alone is 1.8–2.9× the entire goal. Whether the pilot "passes" is decided by the baseline, not by SpeedWorkers.	What SpeedWorkers would actually have to generate for the contract to show 45.3M. Our high case: 31M at Sep 1, 20M at Sep 24.

No tier of our forecast reaches any checkpoint at any launch date.

Frank's model reproduces the addendum's figures exactly. Re-run at Sep 1, 17 and 24 launches, converted to visits at Walmart's own ratio, with AI visits added.

- Walmart's \$16.4 goals
- Our high case, launch Sep 1
- High case, Sep 17
- High case, Sep 24
- Low case (contract tier), Sep 24



CUMULATIVE INCREMENTAL VISITS	SEP 30	OCT 31	NOV 30	DEC 20	GOAL ÷ OURS
Walmart's goal	8.7M	18.4M	30.9M	45.3M	—
Our high case · launch Sep 1	2.6M	9.7M	21.0M	31.3M	1.4×
Our high case · launch Sep 24	0.3M	4.0M	12.0M	20.3M	2.2×
Our mid case · launch Sep 24	0.1M	1.5M	4.8M	8.5M	5.3×
Contract low tier · launch Sep 24	0.01M	0.2M	0.7M	1.7M	27×

The September checkpoint is impossible on any date. 8.7M by Sep 30 is more than our high case earns by Halloween; month one of any deployment runs at 2–20% of full pace while engines recrawl. The launch slip also loses the Full Scale gate (80% served by Sep 30): 40% on a Sep 17 launch, 18% on Sep 24. Adjustment Days relieve thresholds but do not restore a missed gate — and even relieved, 45.3M becomes 22.8M, still above our high case.

As growth: 45.3M is a +10.6% lift on Walmart's entire organic + AI base in twelve weeks, during ramp-up, touching only the non-branded 6% of that base. At full coverage for a full year our model lifts the base +4% (low), +7.5% (mid), +11% (high). The ask equals the high case's annual output, delivered in one quarter, against a channel losing 11–20% a year.

If 45.3M is actually a 12-month goal (Matt Kennedy's framing to Adrian), the number itself becomes reasonable. Over the first twelve months from launch our model produces 22M (low), 71M (mid) and 147M (high) incremental visits — 45.3M sits between low and mid. But the document as written says "by the Measurement Close Date," the interim checkpoints are dated Sep 30 / Oct 31 / Nov 30 and cannot be annual, and the Annex A baseline problem is untouched. It needs to be corrected in the document, not in a text message.

Sources: Google Search Console via Botify (walmart.com US/Web, daily, to 5 Sep 2026) · Bing Webmaster Tools · Walmart scorecards W16–W17 FY27 · Frank Vitovitch, forecast.py (13 Aug 2026) · Annex A and \$16.4 as received from Walmart.